

ECMWF SEAS5 initialized 1 February 2026 · calibrated with CHIRPS v2.0 · FMAM rainfall domain (FMAM  $\geq$  20% of annual rainfall)

**Research reconstruction — not an official EMI or ICPAC forecast**

The forecast leans toward above normal rainfall in the FMAM rainfall domain (FMAM  $\geq$  20% of annual and  $\geq$  100 mm): averaged over the area, the local probability of above normal is 43%, against about 33% for climatology. Mean forecast rainfall is 316 mm against a 1993–2025 average of 287 mm (+29 mm, +10%).

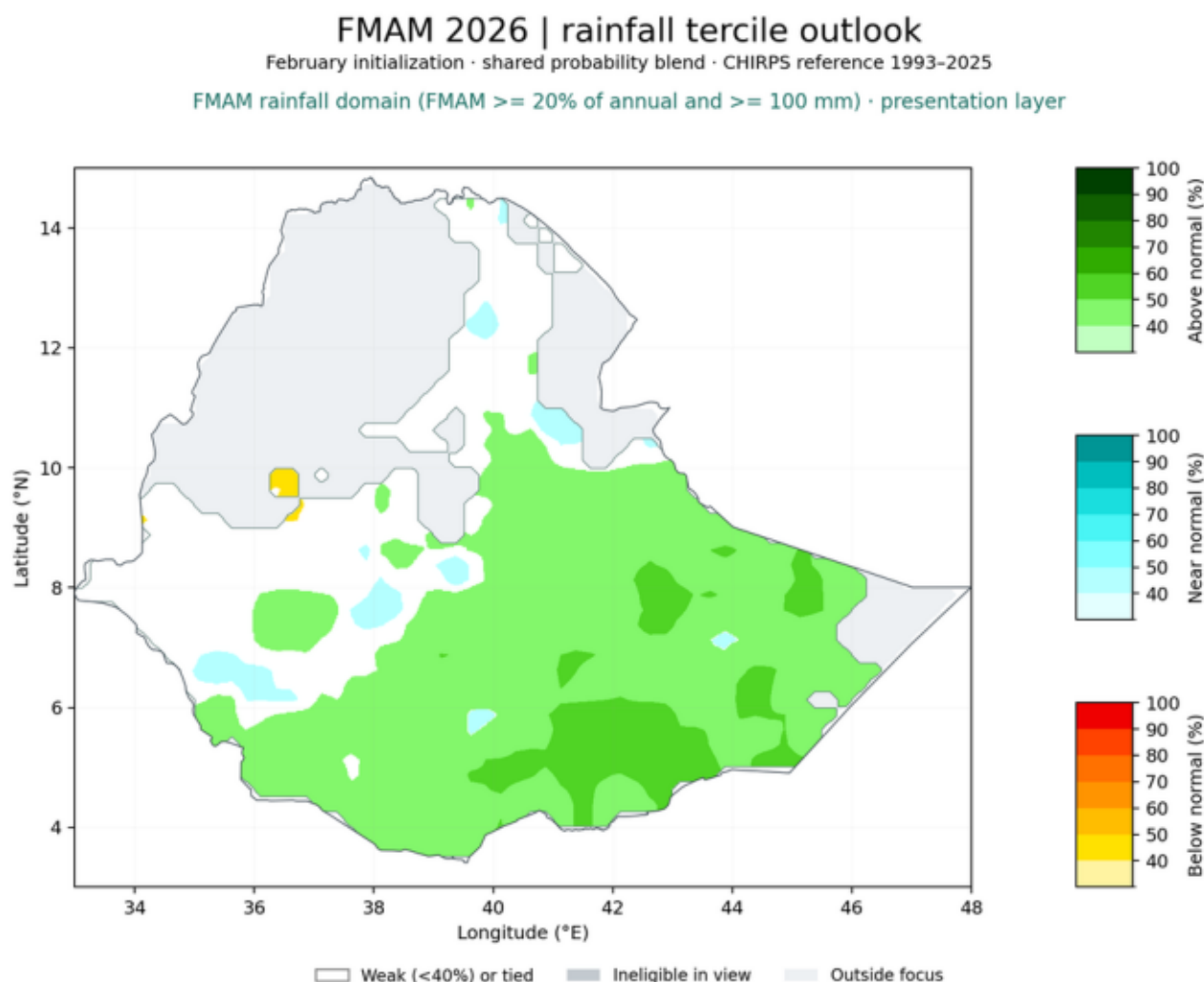


**Below normal 24%      Near normal 33%      Above normal 43%**

Average local probability: each grid cell has its own tercile probabilities; these are their averages over the 100% of the area that has probabilities, not the probability that the area-total rainfall falls in a category.

Forecast signal: Weak tilt toward above normal (largest area-average probability compared with a one-third reference; based on probabilities only).

Historical skill (FMAM rainfall domain (FMAM  $\geq 20\%$  of annual and  $\geq 100$  mm)): Small estimated improvement; skill uncertain. Probability skill (RPSS) +0.020, cross-validated 1993–2016, 95% interval  $-0.042$  to  $+0.077$ ; better than climatology in 15 of 24 years. A strong signal is not a confidence rating.



Display interpolation: 12x; Gaussian  $\sigma=0.6$  native cells. Statistics and exported fields use the original  $0.25^\circ$  grid.  
Research reconstruction of a February-initialized forecast; not an official EMI/ICPAC product.

# All targets, evidence and record

FMAM 2026 — February initialization · FMAM rainfall domain (FMAM >= 20% of annual and >= 100 mm)

| Target    | Below/near/above | Coverage | Anomaly | Verification status    |
|-----------|------------------|----------|---------|------------------------|
| FMAM 2026 | 24% / 33% / 43%  | 100%     | +29 mm  | Verification published |
| Feb 2026  | 28% / 45% / 27%  | 81%      | −2 mm   | Verification published |
| Mar 2026  | 31% / 34% / 35%  | 91%      | +4 mm   | Verification published |
| Apr 2026  | 27% / 30% / 43%  | 100%     | +26 mm  | Verification published |
| May 2026  | 35% / 33% / 32%  | 100%     | −2 mm   | Verification published |

## Historical skill, cross-validated (probability skill, RPSS, with whole-year 95% interval)

| Target | RPSS (95% interval)       | Yrs better | Holm p | In words                                                    |
|--------|---------------------------|------------|--------|-------------------------------------------------------------|
| FMAM   | +0.020 (−0.042 to +0.077) | 15/24      | 1.000  | Small estimated improvement; skill uncertain                |
| Feb    | +0.145 (+0.050 to +0.247) | 17/24      | 0.018  | Moderate improvement over climatology (interval above zero) |
| Mar    | +0.011 (−0.032 to +0.054) | 17/24      | 1.000  | Small estimated improvement; skill uncertain                |
| Apr    | +0.012 (−0.033 to +0.051) | 14/24      | 1.000  | Small estimated improvement; skill uncertain                |
| May    | +0.011 (−0.056 to +0.061) | 17/24      | 1.000  | Small estimated improvement; skill uncertain                |

## Verification against CHIRPS (single season or month)

| Target    | RPSS   | CRPSS  | Bias     | Forecast / observed anomaly | Observed below/near/above |
|-----------|--------|--------|----------|-----------------------------|---------------------------|
| FMAM 2026 | +0.130 | +0.062 | −27.0 mm | +29 / +56 mm                | 3% / 45% / 52%            |
| Feb 2026  | +0.142 | +0.048 | −2.1 mm  | −2 / 0 mm                   | 32% / 44% / 24%           |
| Mar 2026  | +0.066 | +0.057 | −72.1 mm | +4 / +77 mm                 | 0% / 2% / 98%             |
| Apr 2026  | −0.159 | −0.633 | +41.9 mm | +26 / −16 mm                | 44% / 37% / 19%           |
| May 2026  | +0.002 | −0.056 | +3.6 mm  | −2 / −5 mm                  | 38% / 44% / 18%           |

## Cycle record

Model initialization: 1 February 2026 · ECMWF SEAS5 (system 51), 51 members

Target period: 1 Feb 2026 – 31 May 2026

Forecast record: Frozen 9 Oct 2026 (after the target period ended, before this project downloaded its observations; SHA-256 manifest)

Publication status: Research reconstruction: produced after the initialization date with the published method; not an official EMI or ICPAC forecast

Reference period: CHIRPS v2.0 FMAM 1993–2025 (33 seasons)

Observations processed through: May 2026 (Feb, Mar, Apr, May)

CHIRPS archive: Official CHIRPS v2.0 p25 by\_month listing checked 10 Oct 2026: monthly files through Aug 2026; Feb 2026 file not found

Verification last run: 10 Oct 2026

Method / version: Shared climatology blend ( $\lambda = 0.44$  for FMAM) · code 535e338

How to read: terciles split the reference-period rainfall into three equally likely parts. Climatology assigns about one-third to each (the observed tercile frequencies of the training years). Skill scores are decimals: +0.05 means a 5% lower score than climatology. RPSS refers to the blended probabilities; CRPSS and bias to the amount-corrected ensemble.

Limitations: few evaluation years and single verification seasons give wide uncertainty; the 0.25° maps repeat ~1° model information; the rainfall domain is for display and summaries only.

# Monthly tercile outlooks

FMAM 2026 — February initialization · FMAM rainfall domain (FMAM  $\geq 20\%$  of annual and  $\geq 100$  mm)

